

CHAPTER THREE

PUJĀ TO THE GODS OF THE STAGE

Consecration of the playhouse

1-8. In the auspicious playhouse constructed with all the characteristics [mentioned above] cows, and Brahmins muttering [proper Mantras] should be made to dwell for a week. Then the master of the dramatic art who has been initiated [for the purpose] and has put on new cloths, fasted for three days, lived away from his bed-room (lit. the dwelling house), has kept his senses under control and has [thus] become purified, will besprinkle his limbs with water over which purificatory Mantras have been muttered, and consecrate the playhouse. This [consecration] should take place after he has made obeisance to the great god Śiva the lord of all the regions, Brahman who sprung from the lotus, Brahaspati the preceptor of the gods, Viṣṇu, Kārtikeya, Sarasvatī, Lakṣmī, Siddhi, Medhā, Smṛti, Mati, Candra (Moon), Sūrya (Sun), Winds, Guardians of all directions, Aśvins, Mitra, Agni, and other gods, such as Rudra, Varṇas¹, Kāla², Kali³, Yama, Niyati, the Sceptre of Yama⁴, Weapons of Viṣṇu⁵, the Lord of the Nāgas (Serpents), the Lord of the birds (Garuḍa), Thunderbolt, Lightning, Seas, Gandharvas, Apsarasas, Sages, Nātya-maids⁶, Mahāgrāmāṇī (the great leader of Gaṇas)⁷, Yakṣas, Guhyakas⁸ and the hosts of Bhūtas.

1-8 (B.1-7, 9. G.1-7, 9). ¹ *varṇas*—No gods called *varṇas* are to be met with in any other work. They may be taken as deities ruling specially over the four *varṇas* of people.

² *Kāla*—There are several legendary heroes (gods, sages and Asuras) of this name, see Vidyānāṅka, JK. *sub voce*.

³ *Kali*—There are many legendary heroes of this name, see JK. *sub voce*.

⁴ See note 5 below.

⁵ Weapons of Viṣṇu appear as deities in the Act. I of Bhāsa's *Bāla*.

⁶ *nātyakumārī*—Such goddesses are possibly mentioned nowhere else.

⁷ *mahāgrāmāṇī*—The great leader of Gaṇas. It is very difficult to accept Ag's identification of *mahāgrāmāṇī* with Gaṇapati (*mahāgrāmāṇīr gaṇapatiḥ*). For in 58 below, occurs the term *mahāgaṇaiśvara*

9-10. Having made obeisance to these, and other divine sages (*devarṣi*), he should with folded palms invoke all the gods to their respective positions, and say, "Ye, holy ones, should take us under your protection during the night, and ye with your followers should offer us assistance in this dramatic performance".

Offering Pūjā to the Jarjara

11-13. Having worshipped [thus] all the gods as well as all the musical instruments (*kutapa*)¹ he should offer Pūjā to the Jarjara² for attaining good success at the performance [and pray to it as follows]. "Thou art Indra's weapon killing all the demons ; thou hast been fashioned by all the gods, and thou art capable of destroying all the obstacles ; bring victory to the king and defeat to his enemies, welfare to cows and Brahmins and progress to dramatic undertakings".

14-15. After proceeding thus according to rules and staying in the playhouse for the night, he (the master of the dramatic art)

(in the plural number) indicating the different leaders of Gaṇas who followed Śiva. One of such leaders has been mentioned there as Nandīśvara (Nandin). Besides this the term Gaṇeśa (the leader of Gaṇas) has also been applied to Śiva in 47 below. In describing *piṇḍibādhās* the *piṇḍi* of Gaṇeśvara has been named as *dakṣayajña-vimardini* (Nś. IV. 260). This too shows that *gaṇeśvara*, *grāmaṇi* or *mahāgrāmaṇi* meant simply the leader, one of the leaders or the great leader of Gaṇas. The fully developed Gaṇapati seems to be non-existent at the time when the Nś. was composed. Our suspicion in the matter seems to be corroborated by the variant *tathā grāmūdhi-devatā* recorded in the ms *ṭha* of B. for *mahāgrāmaṇyam*. Gaṇapati seems to be a late entrant into the Hindu pantheon. He is not mentioned in any one of the old Purāṇas. Only the Varāha, Vāmana and Brahma-vaivarta P. which are very late know the deity (Winternitz, Vol. 1. pp. 566-568, 573, Vidyalankar, JK. *sub voce*).

² Kalidāsa makes no distinction between Yakṣas and Guhyakas, See Meghadūta 1 and 5.

³ See above..

9-10 (B.10-11, G.10-11).

11-13 (B.12-14, G.12-14). ¹ See below 72-73 note 3. The reading *samprayuja* in all editions and mss. seems to be wrong. It should be emended as *samprapūjya*.

² See 73-81 below.

14-15 (B.15-16, G.15-16).

should begin Pūjā as soon as it is morning. This Pūjā connected with the stage should take place under the asterism Ārdrā (*Alpha-Orionis*) or Maghā (*Regulus*) or Yāmyā (*Musca*) or Pūrvaphalgunt (*Delta-Leonis*) or Pūrvāṣāḍhā (*Delta-Sagittarii*) or Pūrvabhādrapadā (*Alpha-Pegasi*) or Āśleṣā (*Hydrae*) or Mūlā (*Lambda-Scorpionis*).

16. The stage should be illuminated and the Pūjā of the gods in its connexion should be performed by the master of the dramatic art (*ācārya*) after he has purified his body, concentrated his mind [to these acts] and initiated himself [to the Pūjā].

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Installation of the gods

17. During the concluding moments of the day, which are considered to be hard and full of evils, and are presided over by Bhūtas, one should perform Ācamana¹ and cause the gods to be installed.

18. [Along with these gods] should be [taken] red thread-bangle (*pratisarā*)¹, the best kind of red sandal, red flowers and red fruits. [With these and] articles such as barley, white mustard, sunned rice, Nāgapuṣpa² powder and husked saffron (*priyaṅgu*)³, the gods should be installed.

The Maṇḍala for installing the gods

20. In this ceremony one should draw in proper place a Maṇḍala¹ according to the manner prescribed.

21. This maṇḍala should be sixteen Tālas (*hasta*)¹ square and it should have doors on all its four sides.

16 (B.17, G.17).

17 (B.18, G.18). ¹ *ācamana*—ceremonial rinsing of the mouth by sipping water from the palm of the hand.

18-20 (B.19-21a, G.19-21a).

¹ *pratisarā—sūtra-vinirmīta granthi-mantaḥ kaikaṇaviśeṣaḥ*, Ag. (I. p. 74).

² *nāgapuṣpa*=the *campaka* tree (Apte), but Ag. says *nāgapuṣpam nāgadantaḥ*.

³ *priyaṅgu*=saffron, and not the fruit of the *priyaṅgu* creeper.

20 (B.21b-G.21b). ¹ See the diagram 1.

21 (B.22-G.22). ¹ *hasta* in this passage is to be interpreted as

22. In its middle should be drawn two lines vertically and horizontally (*i.e.* parallel to the sides), and in the apartments made by these lines, should be installed the different gods.

23-30. In the middle of this (*maṇḍala*), should be put Brahman who has lotus as his seat¹. Then one should first of all put in the east Śiva with his host of Bhūtas, Nārāyaṇa (Viṣṇu), Indra, Skanda (Kārtikeya), Sūrya, Aśvins, Candra, Sarasvatī, Lakṣmī, Śraddhā and Medhā, in the south-east Agni, Svāhā, Viśvedevas, Gandharvas, Rudras and Ṛṣis, in the south Yama, Mitra with his followers, Pitr̥s, Pisācas, Urugas and Guhyakas, in the south-west the Rākṣasas and all the Bhūtas, in the west the Seas and Varuṇa, in the north-west the Seven Winds² and Garuḍa with other birds, in the north Kuvera, Mothers of the Nāṭya, Yakṣas with their followers, in the north-east leaders of Gaṇas such as Nandin, Brahmaṛṣis and the host of Bhūtas in their proper places.

31. And [in the eastern] pillar should be placed Sanat-kumāra¹, in the southern one Dakṣa², in the northern one Grāmaṇi (lit. leader of Gaṇas)³ and in the western one Skanda (Kārtikeya).

32. According to this rule all the gods in their [proper] form and colour should be placed in their respective positions.

hasta-tāla or *tāla* *i.e.* the interval between the tips of the thumb and the middle-finger stretched in opposite directions. अङ्गुलमञ्जनाङ्गुली द्वे दक्षस्य प्रवृत्तिरे । तद्वयोरन्तराखं ताक्षमाङ्गुलीविषयः ॥ SR. VII. 1046. Otherwise it will be impossible to accomodate the *maṇḍala* on the stage which is eight cubits wide (See NS. II. 33-35). The ancient commentators like Śaṅkuka and others pointed out how absurd it would be to take *hasta* in the passage in the sense of cubit. (see Ag. I. p. 75). 22 (B.23. G.23).

23-30 (B.24-31, G.24-31). ¹ According to Ag. a lotus is to be described in the centre of *maṇḍala*. ² For the seven winds see the Vāmana P. (see Vidyānankar, JK. *sub voce*).

31 (B.32, G.32). ¹ Sanatkumāra—one of the great ṛṣis, and a son of Brahman.

² Dakṣa—one of the lords of the creation (*prajāpati*), son of Pra-cetas. There were other Dakṣas besides. See Vidyānankar, JK. *sub voce*.

³ See above 1-8 note 7.

32 (B.33, G.33).

Offering Pūjā to the gods

33. After they have been installed with regular ceremony in suitable places they should be worshipped in a fitting manner.

34. Gods [in general] should be given white¹ garlands and unguents, while Gandharvas, Agni and Sūrya should be given garlands and unguents of red² colour.

• 35. After being treated [thus] in due order and manner they should be worshipped according to rules with suitable offerings.

36-39. [Offerings suitable to different gods and goddesses are as follows]: Brahman Madhuparka¹, Sarasvatī Pāyasa², gods like Śiva, Viṣṇu, and Indra sweetmeats. Agni rice cooked with ghee, Candra and Sūrya rice cooked with molasses, Viśvedevas, Gandharvas and sages honey and Pāyasa, Yama and Mitra cakes and sweetmeats, Pitṛs, Piśācas and Uragas ghee and milk, host of Bhūtas rice cooked with meat, wines of different kinds and grams covered with thick milk.

Consecration of the Mattavāraṇi

40-44 Similar shall be the rules regarding the Pūjā in connexion with the Mattavāraṇi. [Offerings to be made to different gods and demigods are as follows]: Rākṣasas half-cooked meat, Dānavas wine and meat, the remaining gods cake and Utkarikā³ and boiled rice, gods of seas and rivers fish and cakes, Varuṇa ghee and Pāyasa, Sages various roots and fruits, the wind god and birds different edible stuff (lit. *bhakṣya* and *bhojya*), Mothers⁴ of the

33 (B.34, G.34).

34 (B.35, G.35). ¹ 'White' here seems to be the symbol of purity and good grace.

² 'Red' here seems to be the symbol of energy.

35 (B. 35, G.36).

36-39. (B. 37-40, G. 37-40). ¹ *madhuparka*—see above II. 41-42. note 3.

² *pāyasa*—see above II. 41-42 note.

40-44. (B.41-45, G.41-45). ¹ See above.

² *utkarikā*—a kind of sweetmeat.

³ These goddesses seem to have been ignored by the Purāṇas.

Nāṭya, and Kuvera with his followers eatables including cakes, and Locikās⁴.

45. These different kinds of foodstuffs should be offered to them and the Mantras to be uttered at the time of making offering to different gods will be as follows :—

46. (The Mantra for Brahman), O the god of gods, the most lordly one, the lotus-born one, the grand-father (of the worlds) accept this my offering consecrated by the Mantra.

47. (For Śiva) O the god of gods, the great god, the lord of Gaṇas¹ and the killer of Tripura, accept this my etc.

48. (For Viṣṇu), O Nārāyaṇa, Padmanābha, the best of the gods, with unrestrained movement, accept this my etc.

49. (For Indra), O Purandara, the lord of gods, the thunder bearer, the maker of the hundred exploits, accept this my etc.

50. (For Skanda), O Skanda the leader of the celestial army, the blessed one, the dear son of Śiva, O the six-mouthed one, accept this my etc.

51. (For Sarasvatī), O the goddess of the gods, the very blessed one, the dear wife of Hari, accept this my etc.

52. (For goddesses Lakṣmī, Siddhi, Matī, Medhā) O Lakṣmī, Siddhi, Matī and Medhā, ye who are honoured by all the worlds, accept this my etc.

53. (For Māruta) O Māruta, you who know the might of all the creatures and are the life of all the world, accept this my etc.

54. (For Rākṣasas) O the great Rākṣasas, the great-souled

⁴ *locikā*—This has been read in mss. as *locilā*, *loṣikā*, *lepikā*, *lipikā*. The word seems to be connected with the NIA. *luci*, *loci*, from *lociū*, *locikū*.

45 (B. 46, G. 46)

36 (B. 47, G. 47).

47 (B. 51, G. 48). It should be marked here that Śiva has been called Gaṇeśvara, a term applied in later times to Gaṇapati only.

48 (B. 50, G. 49).

49 (B. 48, G. 50).

50 (B. 49, G. 51).

51 (B. 53, G. 52).

52 (B. 55, G. 55).

53 (B. 56, G. 53).

54 (B. 54, G. 54).

ones, the sons of Pulastya, born of different causes, accept this my etc.

55. (For Agni) O Agni, the mouth of the gods, the best of the gods, the smoke-bannered one, the eater of things offered in sacrifice, accept this my offering given with love.

56. (For Candra) O Soma, the lord of all the planets, the king of the twice-born ones, the favourite of the world, accept this my etc.

57. (For Sūrya) O the maker of day, the mass of heat, the best among the planets, accept this my etc.

58. (For lords of Gaṇas such as, Nandiśvara) O the great lord of Gaṇas, among whom Nandiśvara is the foremost, accept this my etc.

59. (For Pitr̥s) I bow to all the Pitr̥s, do ye accept my offering. (For Bhūtas) I always bow to all the Bhūtas who may have a liking for offerings¹.

60a. (For Kāmapāla) O Kāmapāla, I always bow to thee to whom this offering is made.

60-61. (For Gandharvas) O Gandharvas, amongst whom Nārada, Tumburu and Viśvāvasu are the foremost, accept this my best offering.

61-62. (For Yama and Mitra) O Yama and Mitra, the gods who are adored by all the worlds, accept this my etc.

62-63. (For Nāgas) I bow to all the Pannagas in the nether region, who are devourers of wind, give me success in dramatic production after I have worshipped you.

63-64. (For Varuṇa) O Varuṇa, you who are the lord of all waters and have the swan as your mount, be pleased along with the seas and rivers, after I have worshipped you all.

55 (B.57, G.56).

56 (B.58, G.57).

57 (B.59, G.68).

58 (G.60, B.59).

59 (B.61, G.60a). ¹ G. puts one hemistich after 60a without numbering it.

60a (B.62a, G.62b).

60-61 (B.62b-63a, G.61).

61-62 (B.63b-64a, G.62).

62-63 (B. 64b-65a, G.63).

63-64 (B.65b-65a, G.64).

64-65. (For Garuḍa) O the son of Vinatā, the high-souled one, the lord, the king of all the birds, accept this my etc.

64-66. (For Kuvera) O the superintendent of [all] wealth, the king of Yakṣas, the guardian of the world, the lord of riches, ye along with Guhyakas and Yakṣas accept this my etc.

66-67. (For mothers of the Nāṭya) O mothers of the Nāṭya such as Brāhmi and others, ye be happy and pleased to accept my offering.

67-68. (For others) O weapons of Rudra, ye accept my offerings. O weapons of Viṣṇu, ye too accept [things given by me] out of devotion for Viṣṇu.

68-69. O Yama, the Fate, the dispenser of death to all creatures and the end of all actions, accept my offerings.

69-70. Ye other gods who are occupying the Mattavāraṇṇī, accept this my etc.

70-71. To all other gods and Gandharvas too who occupy the heavens, the earth, the middle region and the ten directions, these offerings are made (lit. let these be accepted by them).

71-72. Then a [earthen] jar¹ full of water with a garland of leaves in its front, should be placed in the middle of the stage, and a piece of gold should be put into it.

72-73. All the musical instruments covered with cloth should be worshipped with [sweet] scent, flowers, garlands, incense and various eatables hard and soft.¹

64-65 B.66b-67a, G.65).

65-66 (B.67b-68a, G.66).

66-67 (B.68b-69a, G.67).

66-68 (B.69b-70a, G.68).

68-69 (B.70b-71a, G.69).

69-70 (B.71b-72a, G.70).

70-71 (B.72b-73a, G.71).

71-72 (B.73b-74a, G.72). ¹ For the significance of this jar see below 87-89.

72-73 (B.74b-75a, G.76). ¹ This passage with some minor variation has been repeated in B. and G. But this is out of place there. For the order in which musical instruments (*kulapa*) and the Jarjara should be worshipped see 11-13 above.

Consecration of the Jarjara

73-74. Having worshipped all the gods in due order, and offering Pūjā to the Jarjara [in the following manner] one should have the obstacles removed.

74-76. [One should fasten a piece of] white cloth at the top [of the Jarjara], blue cloth at the Raudra joint, yellow cloth at the Viṣṇu joint, red cloth at the Skanda joint, and variegated cloth at the lowest joint¹. And garlands, incense and unguents are to be offered to it (the Jarjara) in a fitting manner.

76-77. Having observed all these rites with incense, garlands and unguents one should consecrate¹ the Jarjara with the following Mantra:

77-78. "For putting off obstacles thou hast been made very strong, and as hard as adamant, by gods such as Brahman.

78-79. Let Brahman with all other gods protect thy top-most part, Hara (Śiva) the second part, Janārdana (Viṣṇu) the third part, Kumāra (Kārtikeya) the fourth part, and the great Pannagas the fifth part.

80-81. Let all the gods protect thee, and be thou blessed. Thou, the killer of foes, hast been born under Abhijit (*Vega*), the best of the asterisms. Bring victory and prosperity to the king!"

Homa or pouring ghee into sacrificial fire

81-82. After the Jarjara has thus been worshipped and all offerings have been made to it, one should with appropriate Mantras perform Homa and pour (ghee) into the sacrificial fire.

82-83. After finishing the Homa he should with the fire lighted [in the place of sacrifice] do the cleaning work (?) which is to enhance the brilliance of the king as well as of the female dancers.

73-74 (B.75b-76a, G.73).

74-76 (B.76b-78a, G.74-75). ¹ For identifying the joints see 78-79 below. 76-77 (B.79b-80a, G.77). 77-78 (B.80b-81a, G.78).

78-80 (B.81b-82, G.79-80a).

80-81 (B. 83b-84a, G.80b-81).

81-82 (B.84b-85a, G. 82).

82-83 (B.85b-86a, G.83).

83-84. After having illumined the king and the dancers together with the musical instruments one should sprinkle them again with water sanctified by the Mantra, and say to them :

84-85. "You are born in noble families and adorned with multitudes of qualities, let whatever you have acquired by virtue of birth, be perpetually yours."

85-86. After saying these words for the happiness of the king, the wise man should utter the Benediction for the success of the dramatic production.

86-87. [The Benediction] : Let mothers such as Sarasvatī, Dhṛtī, Medhā, Hṛī, Śrī, Lakṣmī, and Smṛtī¹ protect you and give you success.

Breaking the Jar

87-88. Then after performing Homa according to rules with ghee and the proper Mantra the master of dramatic art should carefully break the jar.

88-89. In case the jar remains unbroken the king (lit. the master) will have a cause of fear from enemies ; but when it is broken his enemies will meet with their destruction.

Illumination of the stage

89-90. After the breaking of the jar, the master of the dramatic art should illuminate the auditorium (*raṅga*) with a lighted lamp.

90-91. Noisily, that is, with roaring, snapping of fingers, jumping and running about, he should cover the auditorium with that lighted lamp [in his hand].

91-92. Then a fight should be caused to be made [on the

83-84 (B.86b-87a, G.84).

84-85 (87b-88a, G.85).

85-86 B.88b-89a, G.86).

86-87 (B.89b-90a, G.87).

87-88 (B.90b-91a, G.88). ¹ These are the seven Nāṭya-mātrikās.
See 23-30 above.

88-89 B.91b-92a, G.89).

89-90 (B.92b-93a, G.90).

90-91 (B.93b-94a, G.91).

91-93 (B.94b-96a, G.92-93). ¹ *duṇḍubhi*—a kind of drum.

stage] in accompaniment with the sound of all the musical instruments such as conch-shell, Dundubhi¹, Mr̥daṅga² and Paṇava³.

92-93. If the bleeding wounds [resulting from the fight] will be bright and wide, that will be a [good] omen indicating success.

Good results of consecrating the stage

• 93-94. If the stage is properly consecrated it will bring good luck to the king (lit. the master) and to people young and old of the city as well as of the country.

94-95. But when the auditorium is not consecrated in proper manner it will be indifferently held by gods, and there will be an end of the dramatic spectacle, and it will likewise bring evil to the king.

95-96. He who willfully transgresses these rules [of consecration of the stage] and practises [the dramatic art], will soon sustain loss and will be reborn as an animal of lower order.

96-97. Offering worship to the gods of the stage is as meritorious as a [Vedic] sacrifice. No dramatic performance should be made without first worshipping the deities presiding over the stage. When worshipped, they (these gods) will bring you worship, and honoured they will bring you honour. Hence one should by all efforts offer Pūjā to the gods of the stage.

Evils following non-consecration of the stage

98-99. Never will fire fanned by violent wind burn things so quickly, as defective rites will burn quickly [the master of the dramatic art].

99-100. So the stage should be worshipped by the master of the dramatic art who is purified, disciplined and proficient in

¹ *mr̥daṅga*—a kind of earthen drum.

² *paṇava*—a kind of drum.

93-94 (B.96b-97a, G.94).

94-95 (B.97b-98a, G.95).

95-96 (B.98b-99a, G.96).

96-98 (B.99b-101a, G.97-98).

98-99 (B.101b-102a, G.99).

99-100 (B.102b-103a, G.100).

the rules of the art and initiated into the practice of it and has quiet of mind.

100-101. He who with an agitated mind places his offering in a wrong place, is liable to expiation like one who pours ghee into the sacrificial fire without proper Mantras. This is the procedure prescribed for worshipping the gods of the stage. It should be followed by producers [of plays] in holding a theatrical show in a newly built playhouse.

Here ends Chapter III of Bharata's Nāṭyaśāstra,
which treats of Pūjā to the gods of the stage.

100-101 (B.103b-104a, G.101-102).